

Identity Visibility and Intelligence Platforms — What You Need to Know

Nathan Harris

© 2026 Gartner, Inc. and/or its affiliates. All rights reserved. Gartner is a registered trademark of Gartner, Inc. and its affiliates. This publication may not be reproduced or distributed in any form without Gartner's prior written permission. It consists of the opinions of Gartner's research organization, which should not be construed as statements of fact. While the information contained in this publication has been obtained from sources believed to be reliable, Gartner disclaims all warranties as to the accuracy, completeness or adequacy of such information. Although Gartner research may address legal and financial issues, Gartner does not provide legal or investment advice and its research should not be construed or used as such. Your access and use of this publication are governed by [Gartner's Usage Policy](#). Gartner prides itself on its reputation for independence and objectivity. Its research is produced independently by its research organization without input or influence from any third party. For further information, see ["Guiding Principles on Independence and Objectivity."](#)

Gartner®

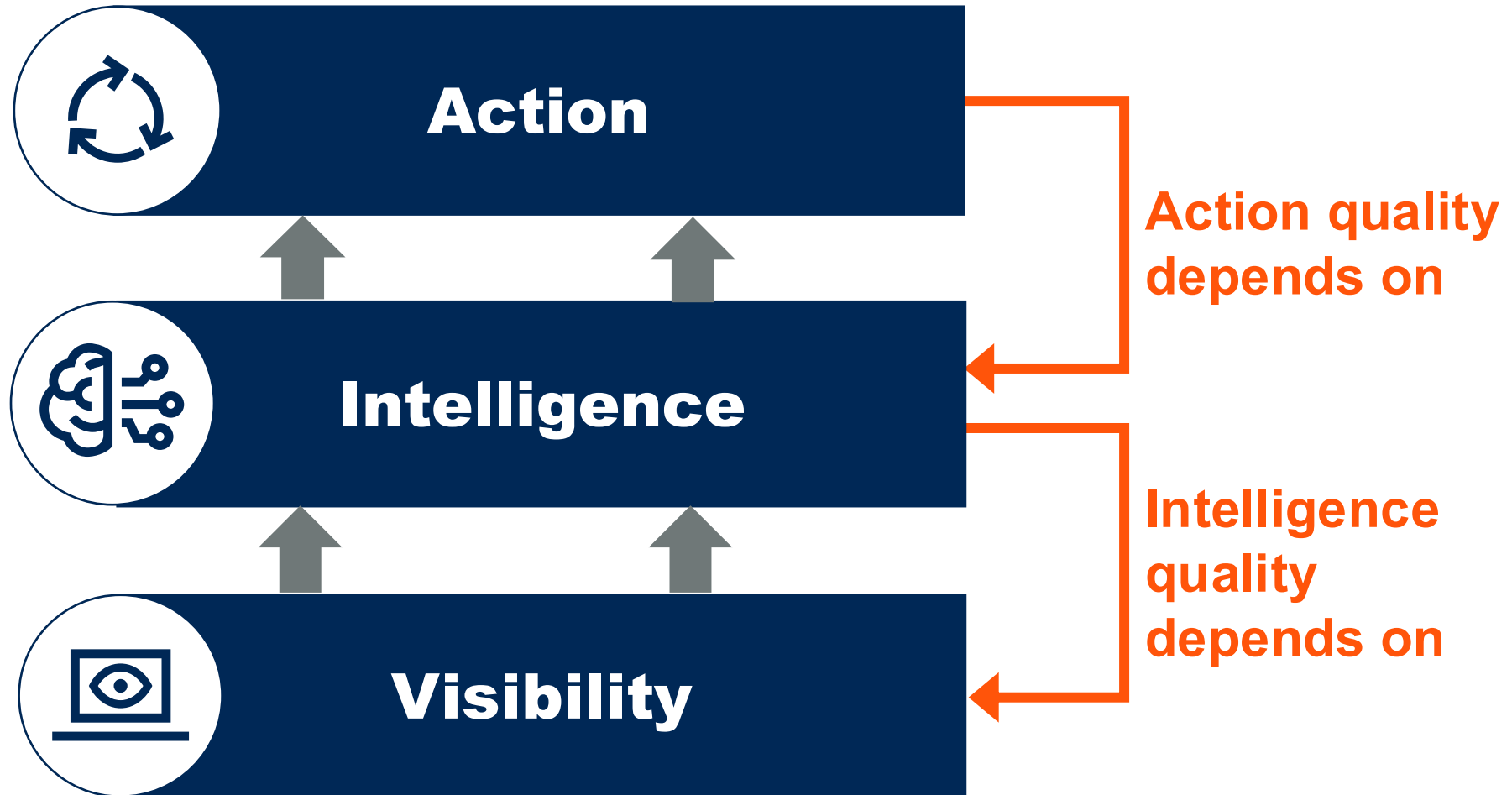
Where is my risk?



What is my highest value process improvement?



The VIA Model Explains Why



IVIP — The Good News

- Major market IAM vendors are expanding visibility and intelligence capabilities
- Substantial startup and innovation activity including uptake of vendor solutions for what we are calling IVIP:

“Identity visibility and intelligence platforms (IVIP) are products that provide rapid integration and visibility for identity and access management (IAM) relevant data, typically paired with advanced analytics (often AI-enabled) capabilities. This innovation provides a single view of IAM data, activity/events, relationships, configuration and posture to enable rapid improvement of all other integrated IAM controls and capabilities supporting both improved security and business enablement.”

Key Issues



What is good enough
visibility?



What is optimal
design for
intelligence?



Who are the vendors
providing IVIP?

Key Issues



What is good enough
visibility?



What is optimal
design for
intelligence?



Who are the vendors
providing IVIP?

How Much Visibility Do You Need?

Security Policies & Standards

Signals (incl. Shared Signals)

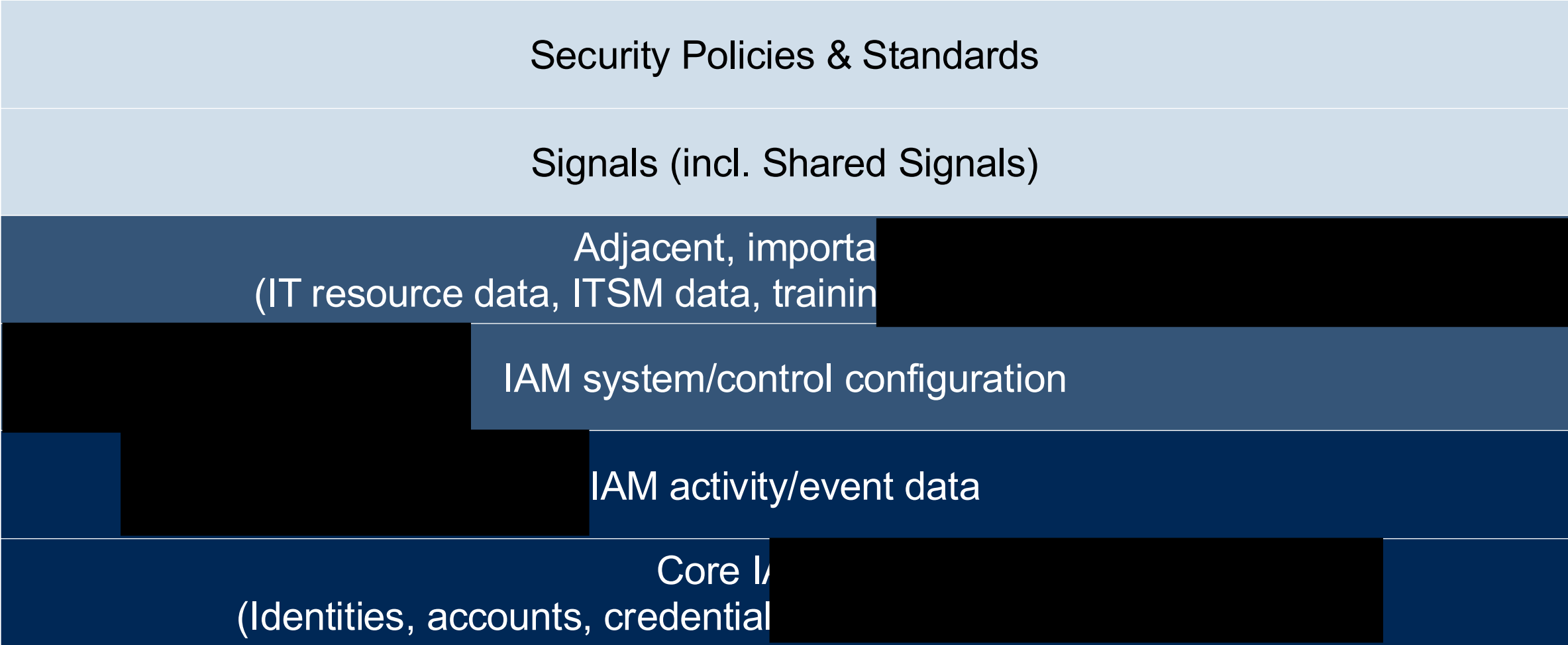
Adjacent, important data
(IT resource data, ITSM data, training, data classification, etc.)

IAM system/control configuration

IAM activity/event data

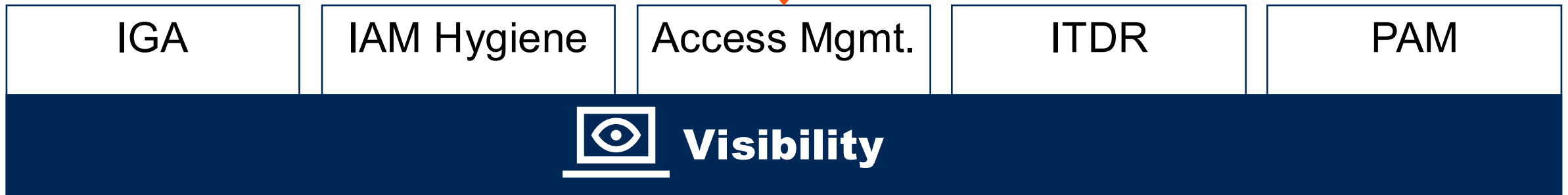
Core IAM Data
(Identities, accounts, credentials, entitlements for all user types)

How Much Visibility Do You Need?



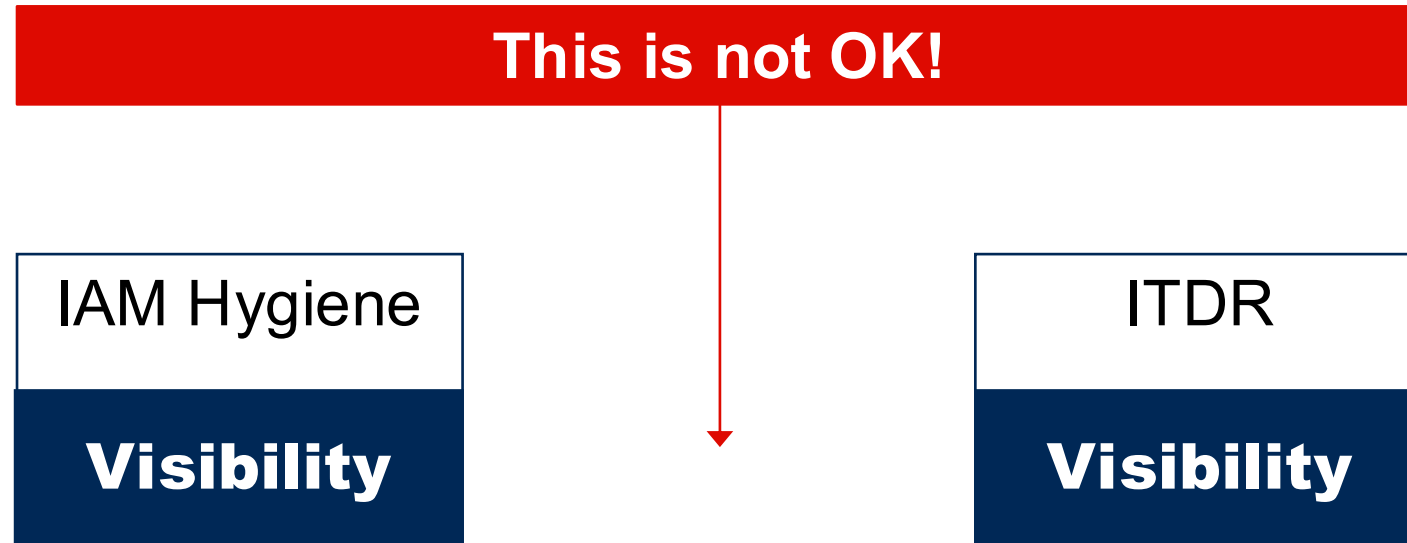
Visibility Supporting IAM Capabilities

Specialization is **Good** for the Action layer capabilities and processes

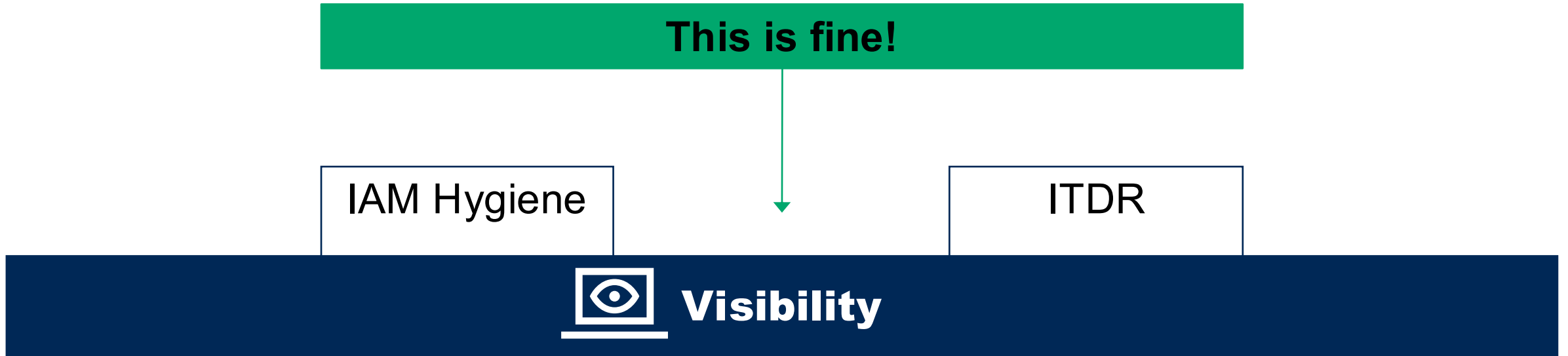


But specialization for visibility layer leads to visibility gaps/blind spots

Visibility Supporting IAM Capabilities



Visibility Supporting IAM Capabilities



Does Discovery Solve for Visibility?

Visibility Use Case	Can Discovery Provide?
Credentials (managed and unmanaged)	
Accounts	
Assigned access/entitlements	
Actor type (human, service, app, container, AI)	
Humans interacting with machine accounts/credentials	
Ownership of machine identities and accounts	
Account to identity linking	
Identity purpose, intent, and authorized business roles	
Full digital identity for ANY actor type	



Regarding Graph and Visibility

Graph helps, but it is not a panacea.

Graph helps by:

- Storing and maintaining visibility into the relationships between your various IAM data sets
- Providing traceability of access to inform analysis & intelligence

However, keep in mind that:

- Graph is the wrong data store for some types of data/visibility, so it cannot be the sole data management and visualization strategy

Ultimately the best data architecture for your identity fabric is a data fabric.



Maximize the value of your IVIP implementation by setting a strategic target of comprehensive visibility.

Key Issues



What is good enough
visibility?



What is optimal
design for
intelligence?



Who are the vendors
providing IVIP?

Where Does Intelligence Work Best?



What is the optimal place to apply analytics and AI between the visibility layer and the various action layer tools and processes?

IGA

IAM Hygiene

Access Mgmt.

ITDR

PAM



Visibility

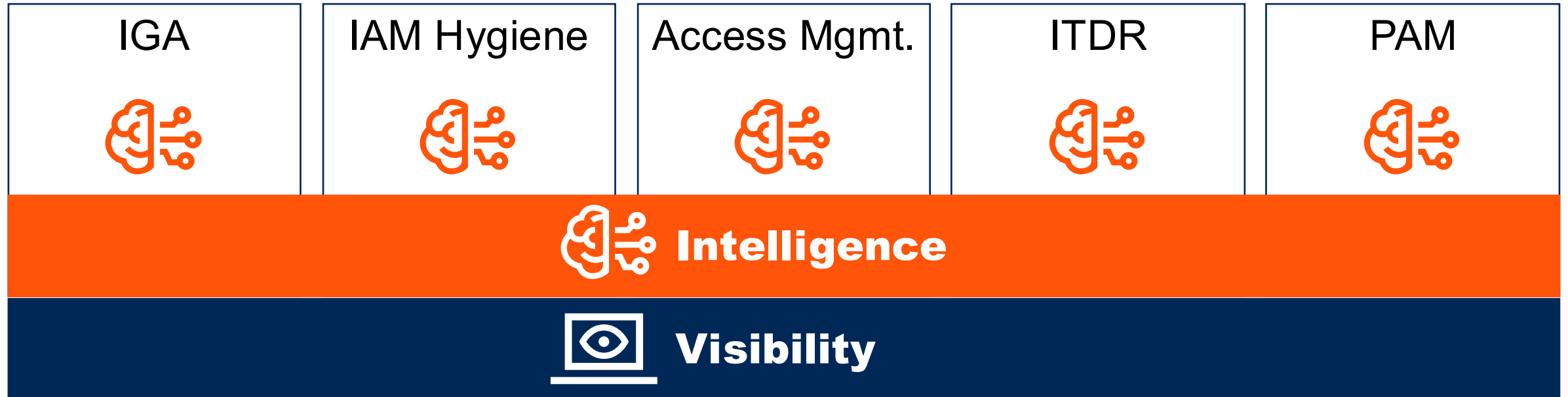
Option 1 — Intelligence With Visibility



Option 2 — Intelligence in Action Layer Components



Option 3 — All of the Above



Intelligence Options

Option	Advantages	Disadvantages
1 – Intelligence with visibility	• Your best visibility/data is available to drive intelligence (no blind spots)	• Maturity of IVIP analytics and AI will vary greatly by use case
2 – Intelligence in action layer tooling	• Built for purpose analytics and intelligence likely higher maturity	• Individual action layer tools likely can't support full visibility, so intelligence may not be "fully informed"
3 – all of the above	• Most practical in the near and mid-term • Leverage the strengths of all IAM components	• Requires the most time for design and solution analysis • May create org role confusion in larger IAM teams

Intelligence for Management Reporting & Dashboards





Use IVIP to provide analytics and AI capabilities to address gaps in other IAM tooling and for program level reporting/dashboards.

Key Issues



What is good enough
visibility?



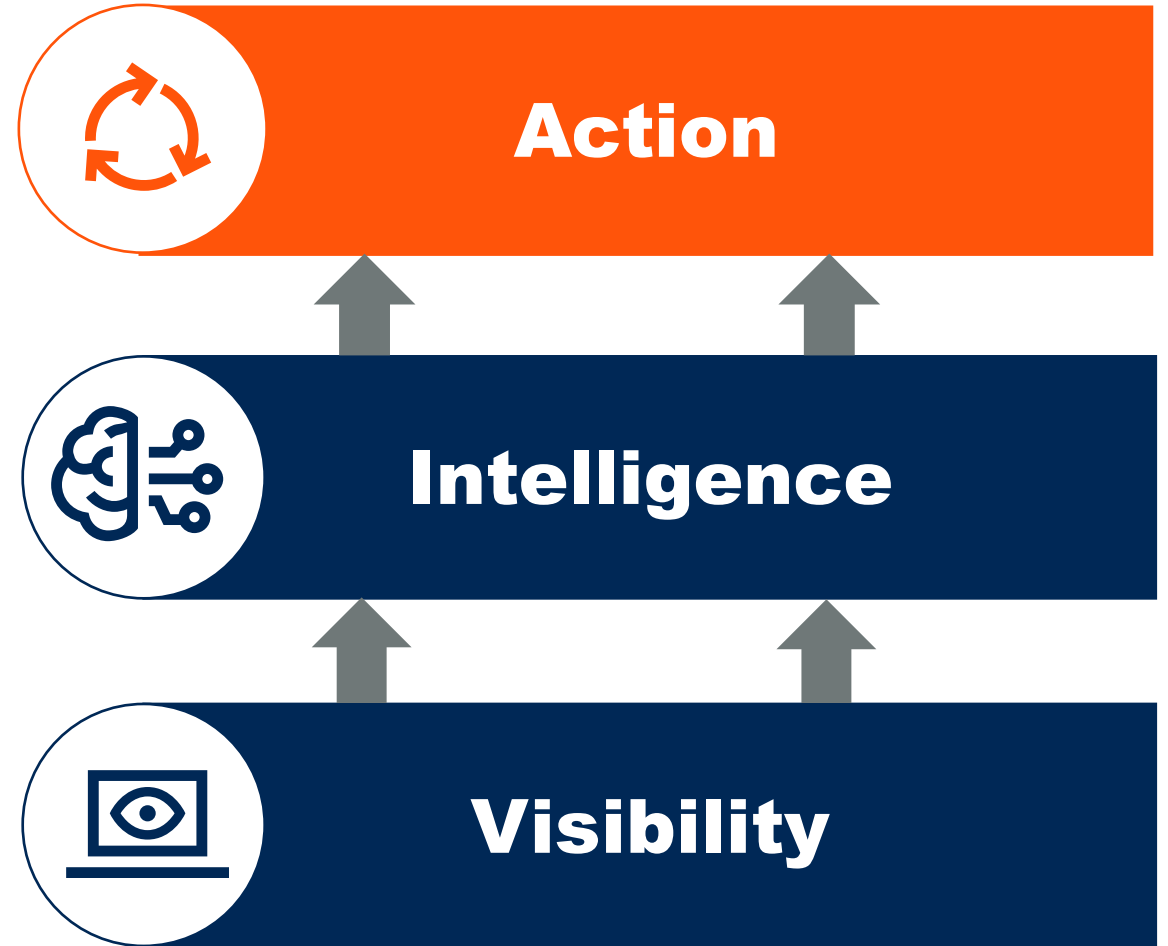
What is optimal
design for
intelligence?



Who are the vendors
providing IVIP?

IAM Technology Spending

- Most of our IAM technology spend has been, understandably, focused on the functional action requirements.
- Some more recent trend toward greater intelligence capability with the AI hype.





Start with what you already have.

Then identify gaps

Gartner

Visibility Capability For IVIP Vendors

Security Policies & Standards	May
Signals (incl. Shared Signals)	
Adjacent, important data (IT resource data, ITSM data, training, data classification, etc.)	Should
IAM system/control configuration	
IAM activity/event data	Must
Core IAM Data (Identities, accounts, credentials, entitlements for all user types)	



Representative Vendors for Identity Visibility & Intelligence Platforms

IVIP Vendors	
AKA Identity	Nexis
Andromeda	Oleria
AuthMind	Radiant Logic
Axonius	SGNL
Elimity	Silverfort
Gurukul	Sphere
	Veza



Achieve **rapid visibility improvement by maximizing existing IAM tech and augmenting with an IVIP solution.**

Recommendations

- ④ Know what types of visibility (data, events, signals, config, etc.) you need and plan for complete visibility as a centralized capability.
- ④ Ensure you can meet your IVIP requirements by requiring a hybrid data architecture (data fabric) in implementation vs. 'just graph'.
- ④ Evaluate the strengths and weaknesses of all of your analytics & intelligence capabilities in order to decide on the best placement of intelligence and AI capabilities in your Identity Fabric
- ④ Make full use of Visibility and Data Management capabilities in your current IAM tech stack before supplementing.
- ④ Evaluate IVIP vendors/solutions to fully meet your business and security outcomes for your IAM program.

Recommended Gartner Research

To learn more about access to Gartner research, expert analyst insight, and peer communities, contact your Gartner representative or click on “Become A Client” on gartner.com to speak with one of our specialists.

- 🔍 [Digital Identity Hype Cycle, 2025](#)
Nayara Sangiorgio, Nathan Harris
- 🔍 [Prioritize IAM Hygiene for Robust Identity-First Security](#)
Rebecca Archambault, Felix Gaehtgens
- 🔍 [Four Data Management Practices to Improve IAM Capabilities](#)
Nathan Harris, Ehtisham Zaidi
- 🔍 [Reduce Your IAM Attack Surface Using Visibility, Observability and Remediation](#)
Rebecca Archambault